

Matthew Bell

VFX ARTIST · CREATIVE TECHNOLOGIST · 28+ YEARS

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PROFILE

VFX artist and creative technologist with 28 years in 3D and visual effects, across feature film, episodic television, commercials, and real-time production. Core specialist in lighting and look development and trusted generalist across the full pipeline. Lighting and look development lead on four films nominated for the Best Visual Effects Oscar (Star Trek, Real Steel, Iron Man 3, Ready Player One), with credits spanning Digital Domain, MPC, The Mill, Method Studios, Zero VFX, Zoic Studios, Blur Studio, and more. Available for VFX consultation across visualization, real-time pipeline, and UI/UX strategy.

AWARD-WINNING & OSCAR-NOMINATED PRODUCTIONS

Academy Award · Nominated Productions · Best Visual Effects (Look Development & Lighting Lead on all four)
Ready Player One (2018) · *Iron Man 3 (2013)* · *Real Steel (2011)* · *Star Trek (2009)* · *Digital Domain*

VES Award · Winning Production · Outstanding Visual Effects in a Commercial (Senior Artist)
Walmart "Famous Visitors" · *The Mill LA, 2020*

Sports Emmy Award · Winning Production · Outstanding Sports Promotional Announcement, Institutional (Lighter)
NFL Network "Run" · *Motion Theory, 2009*

SKILLS & TOOLS

TOOLS

Houdini · Maya · Unreal Engine · Unity · Modo · 3DS Max · Blender · Cinema 4D · Terragen · Gaea · Substance 3D · Nuke · Mari · V-Ray · Arnold · RenderMan · Redshift · 3Delight · XGen · Yeti · After Effects · DaVinci Resolve · Figma · ComfyUI · FLUX.2 · Qwen-Image · Z-Image · Seedance 2 · Kling 3.0 · Veo 3.1 · LTX-2.5 · Wan · TRELIS 2 · Hunyuan 3D · Gaussian splats

SKILLS

Look Development · Lighting · Fur / Hair Groom · Texture Paint · Modeling · Rigging / Animation · Environments · Layout · Compositing · FX / Simulations · Motion Design · Virtual Production · UI/UX · Generative AI / R&D

WORK EXPERIENCE

2020–present **Visualization Consultant - Independent**
Robotics · Fitness Tech · Combat Sports
Real-time, UI/UX, and pipeline consulting

2025 **Reactor VFX · Artjail**
Don't Move (Reactor VFX) · Zillow (Artjail)
Sequence Setups & Sequence Lighting · Environment Builds & Sequence Lighting

2022–24 **Zero VFX**
Sketch · Good Burger 2 · The Instigators · Challengers · Boston Strangler · Spirited · I Wanna Dance with Somebody
Look Development & Fur Groom & Sequence Lighting

WORK EXPERIENCE (CONTINUED)

2021–23	Zoic Studios DC's Legends of Tomorrow · The Flash · Hello Tomorrow! · Mrs. Davis <i>Sequence Lighting · Unreal Engine Environments (The Flash, final season)</i>
2019–21	The Mill LA · Method Studios Nike / Verizon / Ford / GEICO / Harley-Davidson / Walmart / State Farm / Dell / GMC / Disney / Intel / NTT / Liberty Mutual (The Mill LA) · NDA Project (Method Studios) <i>Look Development & Sequence Lighting, including the VES Award-winning Walmart "Famous Visitors" · Visualization</i>
2017–19	Blur Studio · MPC · ETC Love, Death + Robots (Blur Studio) · Honda Ad Campaign (MPC) · Various NDA Projects / Pennzoil (ETC) <i>Assets Department · Look Development & Lighting · Visualization & Look Development & Lighting</i>
2015–17	Digital Domain · ETC · MPC · Iloura Ready Player One / X-Men: Apocalypse / Deadpool / LG Commercial (Digital Domain) · Marmot Super Bowl Commercial (ETC) · Call of Duty Commercial (MPC) · Ted 2 (Iloura) <i>Look Development & Lighting Lead: Ready Player One (Academy Award-nominated, Best Visual Effects) · Look Development & Sequence Lighting</i>
2012–15	Digital Domain · Method Studios · Blur Studio Iron Man 3 / G.I. Joe: Retaliation / Into the Storm / Furious 7 / Blackhat (Digital Domain) · Thor: The Dark World / Divergent / Hercules (Method Studios) · Halo 2: Anniversary (Blur Studio) <i>Look Development & Lighting Lead: Iron Man 3 (Academy Award-nominated, Best Visual Effects) · Look Development & Sequence Lighting</i>
2011–12	Method Studios · Dr. D Studios · Mirada Wrath of the Titans (Method Studios) · Happy Feet Two (Dr. D Studios) · Various Projects (Mirada) <i>Shot Lighting · Sequence Lighting · Shave Hair/Fur TD · Look Development & Lighting</i>
2007–11	Digital Domain · Motion Theory · Logan Star Trek / Speed Racer / Transformers / Real Steel / Gears of War 3 / Lexus / Lincoln / Old Spice / Mazda (Digital Domain) · Pagine Gialle / NFL Network "Run" / Target / Katy Perry "California Gurls" / Various (Motion Theory) · Various Projects (Logan) <i>Look Development & Lighting Lead: Star Trek and Real Steel (Academy Award-nominated, Best Visual Effects) · Modeling, Texturing, Look Development & Sequence Lighting · Lighting: NFL Network "Run" (Sports Emmy winner) · Animation, Look Development & Lighting: other Motion Theory spots</i>
2002–04	News 9 San Antonio · KSAT12 News San Antonio, TX <i>Graphic Designer: broadcast motion graphics and news packaging</i>
1998–2001	NewTek, Inc. · NewTek Europe San Antonio, TX (NewTek, Inc.) · Pessac, France (NewTek Europe) <i>Technical Support LightWave3D Expert / Authorization Program Manager (NewTek, Inc.) · Trade Show Demo Artist and Trainer (NewTek Europe)</i>

EDUCATION

2007	BFA in Visual Effects - Savannah College of Art & Design Minors: Technical Direction & Animation
1999	Associate of Applied Science in Electronic Graphics - San Antonio College
1994–96	Engineering (2 years) - University of Texas